

Go Wirefree!

Today we use myriad devices that could merit the term ‘wireless’—mobile phones, cordless phones, radio equipment, and such. When it comes to information technology, however, ‘wireless’ generally means the ability to create a network *sans* wires.

Networking is key to our computing experience, and the Internet is the biggest network of all. What good is a computer if you can’t connect to your Local Area Network or the Internet? Less than one per cent of the computers in the world are standalone machines that lack the ability to connect to others.

Technology advancement has seen the definition of a PC shift from ‘Personal Computer’ to ‘Portable Computer’. The new breed of laptops are no longer the signature of the higher echelons of management. Today, sales executives and even delivery personnel have mobile devices such as laptops and PDAs to increase efficiency.

With technology becoming more and more portable, networking had to catch up, and thus we have wireless networking, which is fast becoming the solution of the future. This book will cover wireless technologies and devices in order to give you in-depth knowledge, and also to help you set up your own wireless solutions.

The first chapter introduces you to the technologies that power the solutions. The second guides you through the identification of the correct solution for your needs, and then you will learn how to set up your solution in the third chapter.

Chapters four and five show you how you can best use your setup, and how you can prevent unauthorised use from outsiders. These chapters span everything from the coolest wireless gadgets to the tools you need to protect them from hackers.

Chapter six will answer any questions you have about wireless devices, help you troubleshoot problems, and also identify resources that can prove really handy. The Glossary and Bibliography demystify all the jargon you may come across when dealing with wireless technologies, and identify books and resources you should consider in order to take your learning about wireless to the next level. We’ve also included several whitepapers, should you want to explore the subject in even further detail.